ORVYS

2026

1st Edition

Bihar CSR **Outlook Report**

Where CSR money goes in Bihar, where it doesn't, and how companies and the State can close the gap.

November 2026
Published by Orvys

Why a **Bihar CSR Outlook**?

CSR in Bihar has nearly tripled

89.89

INR Cr spent in Bihar, FY 2020-21

260.53

INR Cr spent in Bihar, FY 2023-24 (MCA, National CSR data)

Yet Bihar, home to about 1 in 11 Indians, still receives only about **1%** of India's state-attributed CSR.

Introduction

India's mandated companies spent more than ₹34,900 Cr on CSR in FY 2023-24. Most of it stays near company headquarters and plants in a handful of states. Bihar has few large corporate bases, and its share has stayed small even though its development needs are among the highest in the country.

The **Bihar CSR Outlook Report** is Orvys's annual publication tracking CSR in the state, year after year and district by district. This first edition sets the baseline against which progress will be measured each year until 2030.

About the Report

The report uses official Ministry of Corporate Affairs data reported to Parliament and sets it against Bihar's development indicators. It then sets out seven investment-ready programme areas and a partnership framework for companies and the Government of Bihar.

Research design

Secondary data

MCA21 CSR filings, as reported in Parliament (FY 2020-21 to FY 2023-24)

Development context

NFHS-5, Census 2011, district-level needs and the aspirational districts list, mapped against CSR flows

Ministry of Corporate Affairs, National CSR Portal (csr.gov.in), based on companies' MCA21 filings; Rajya Sabha Unstarred Q. 1010 (9 Dec 2025).

How the report is organised

01
Section 1

Bihar's CSR Landscape

Where Bihar stands nationally, the four-year trend and outlook to FY 2025-26, district-wise flows, and who funds CSR in the state.

02
Section 2

Seven Development Challenges

Nutrition, learning, health, jobs, floods, women's livelihoods and safe water: where each hits hardest and a ready-to-fund programme for each.

03
Section 3

Partnering for Bihar

Recommendations, a proposed partnership with the Government of Bihar, and an open invitation to corporates to join the Bihar CSR Collaborative.

Themes covered across the report

01

CSR flows & trends

02

District equity

03

Development needs

04

Investment programmes

05

Government & corporate partnership

Key Highlights

Bihar's CSR at a glance

₹260.53 Cr
CSR spent in Bihar in FY 2023-24, up 2.9x from ₹89.89 Cr in FY 2020-21

~1.0%
Bihar's share of India's state-attributed CSR, against ~8.6% of the population

₹25
CSR per resident, against an India average of ₹223 and ₹540 in Maharashtra

₹770.8 Cr
total CSR spent in Bihar over four years (FY 2020-21 to FY 2023-24)

Where the money goes

35%
went to just two districts, Muzaffarpur (₹52.00 Cr) and Patna (₹38.72 Cr)

12 of 38
districts received under ₹1 Cr each in FY 2023-24; Arwal received none

₹8.92 Cr
reached the seven Kosi and Seemanchal flood-belt districts combined: 3.4% of the state's CSR for about 16% of its people

Who funds Bihar and what comes next

65%
of FY 2023-24 CSR came from private (non-PSU) companies; PSU spend fell 17% that year

854
companies spent ₹680.91 Cr in Bihar over FY 2021-22 to FY 2023-24: under ₹1 Cr each on average

~₹330 Cr
Orvys estimate for FY 2025-26 if Bihar keeps its current ~1% share

₹1,000 Cr
a year by 2030: the Orvys target if Bihar's share rises to 3%

Section 1:

Bihar's CSR Landscape

FY 2020-21 to FY 2025-26

How much CSR reaches Bihar, how it compares with other states, which districts receive it and who funds it.

Key findings

₹260.53 Cr
CSR in Bihar, FY 2023-24

2.9x
growth since FY 2020-21

₹25
CSR per resident vs ₹223 India average

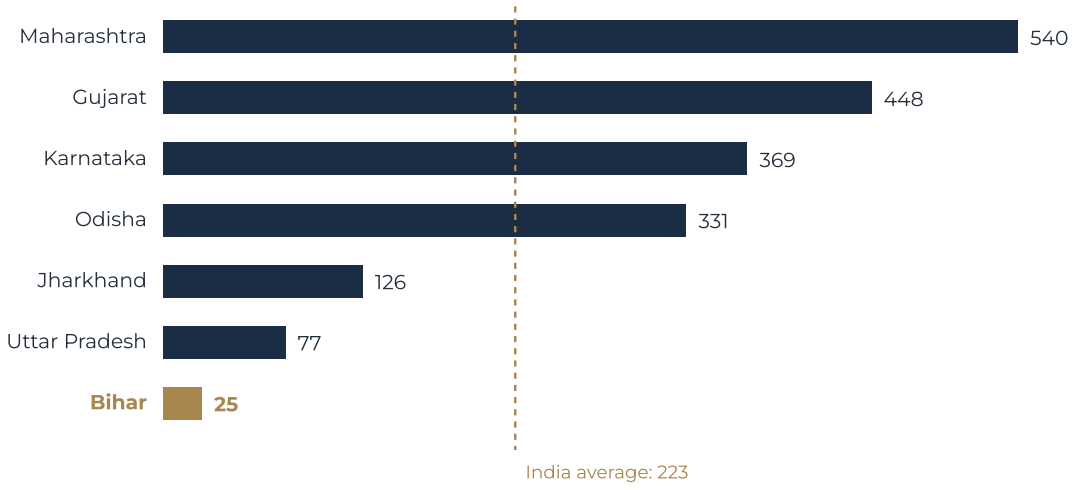
35%
of spend in two districts

Where Bihar stands: one of India's most CSR-underserved states

~1% **of India's state-attributed CSR reached Bihar in FY 2023-24, for ~8.6% of the population**

CSR per resident: Bihar against major states, FY 2023-24

INR per person

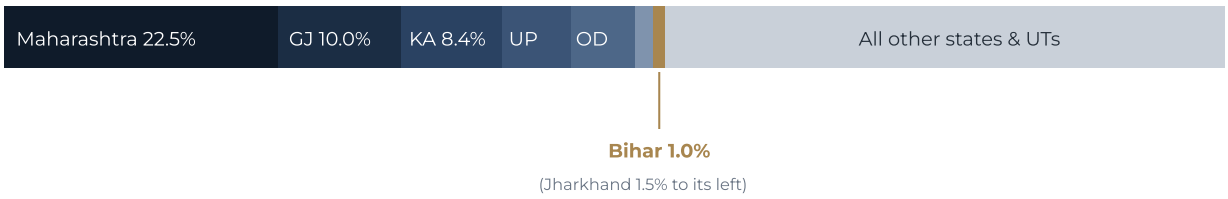


Source: MCA, Lok Sabha Unstarred Q. 2338 (15 Dec 2025), Annexure-I; population, Census 2011; Orvys analysis

Maharashtra received about 22 times more CSR per resident than Bihar. Even neighbouring Jharkhand, with a third of Bihar's population, received more CSR in total (₹414.63 Cr against ₹260.53 Cr).

Share of India's state-attributed CSR, FY 2023-24

% of ₹26,947 Cr traceable to a state

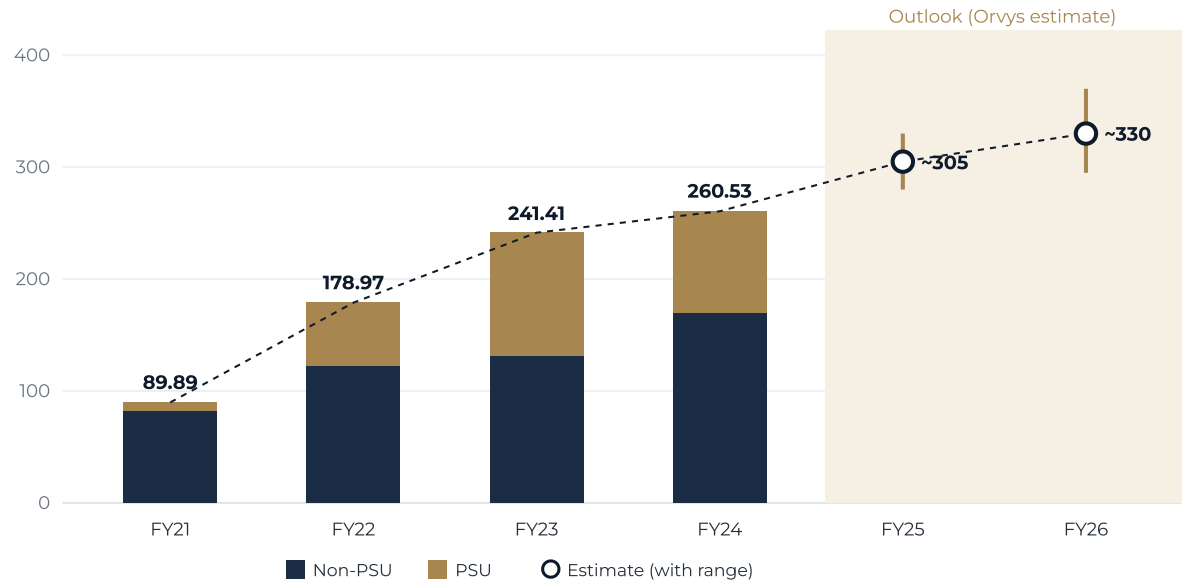


Source: MCA, Lok Sabha Unstarred Q. 2338 (15 Dec 2025). A further ₹7,962 Cr was "PAN India" or not tied to a state.

The trajectory: rising, but slowing

CSR spent in Bihar: actual FY 2020-21 to FY 2023-24 and outlook to FY 2025-26

INR Cr



Source: MCA, Rajya Sabha Unstarred Q. 1010 (9 Dec 2025). FY 2024-25 and FY 2025-26 are Orvys estimates[1].

+99%

growth in FY 2021-22, the fastest year

+8%

growth in FY 2023-24: momentum is fading

-17%

fall in PSU CSR in FY 2023-24 (₹110.29 Cr to ₹91.13 Cr)

₹330 Cr

projected CSR in Bihar, FY 2025-26

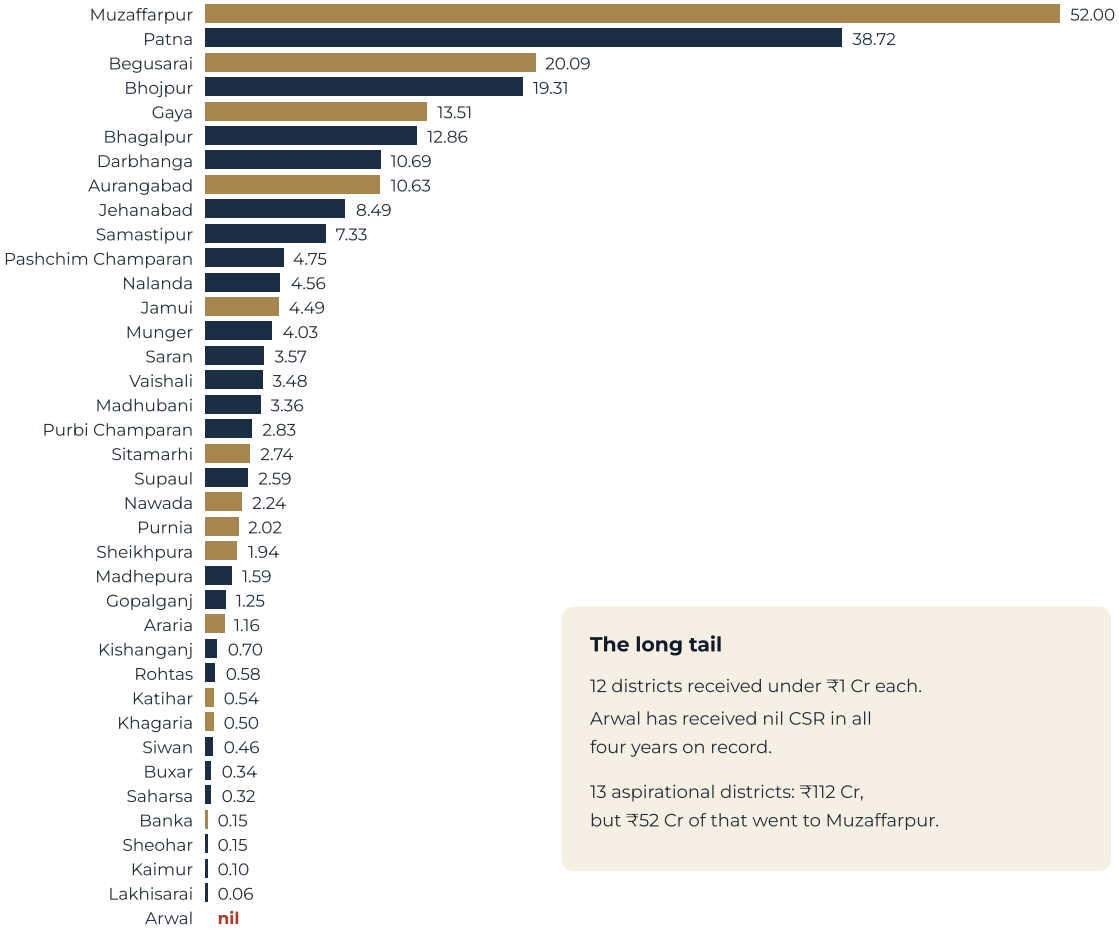
National CSR reached ₹40,794 Cr in FY 2024-25. If Bihar's share stays at ~1%, CSR in the state would reach about **₹305 Cr in FY 2024-25** and **₹330 Cr in FY 2025-26**. At that pace, Bihar would still trail every other large state, which is why active state-level facilitation matters.

[1] *Indicative. Assumes Bihar keeps ~1% of state-attributed CSR (77% of national CSR), with ranges of ₹280-330 Cr (FY25) and ₹295-370 Cr (FY26). Official FY 2024-25 data is due on csr.gov.in.*

District-wise flows: a heavily concentrated picture

CSR received by district, FY 2023-24

INR Cr · all 38 districts · gold = NITI Aayog aspirational district



The long tail

12 districts received under ₹1 Cr each.

Arwal has received nil CSR in all four years on record.

13 aspirational districts: ₹112 Cr, but ₹52 Cr of that went to Muzaffarpur.

Source: MCA, Rajya Sabha Unstarred Q. 1010 (9 Dec 2025). ₹16.41 Cr was not attributed to a single district.

-98%
Kishanganj, FY23→FY24

Volatile, one-off projects

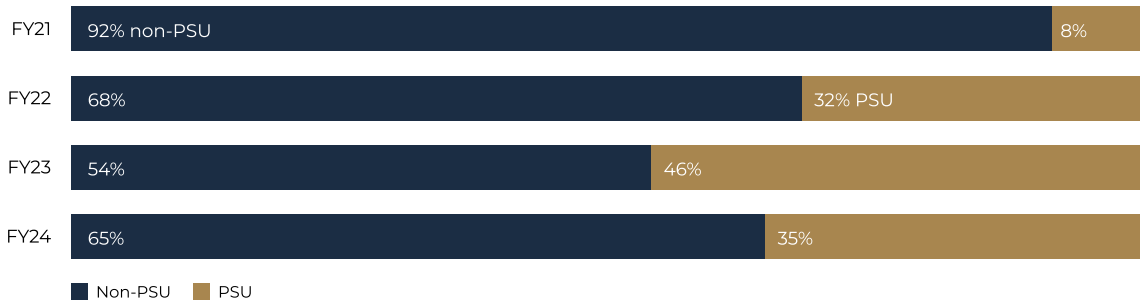
Kishanganj received ₹38.36 Cr in FY 2022-23 and ₹0.70 Cr a year later. Pashchim Champaran fell from ₹39.73 Cr to ₹1.36 Cr after FY 2021-22. Without multi-year commitments, gains do not last.

Who funds CSR in Bihar

65% **of Bihar's FY 2023-24 CSR came from private (non-PSU) companies**

PSU and non-PSU contribution to CSR in Bihar

Share of CSR spent in Bihar, by year



Source: MCA, Rajya Sabha Unstarred Q. 1010 (9 Dec 2025)

Companies with a natural Bihar mandate

Section 135 asks companies to give preference to the local areas around their operations. These operators are natural anchors for scaled CSR in Bihar.

Company	Bihar operations	Districts
NTPC	Barh, Kahalgaon and Nabinagar power stations	Patna, Bhagalpur, Aurangabad
Indian Oil Corporation	Barauni refinery	Begusarai
Central PSUs & infrastructure majors	Rail, power transmission, highways and pipelines	Statewide
Banks, FMCG, telecom & auto	Large customer base and branch or dealer networks in every district	Statewide

854
companies spent CSR in Bihar, FY 2021-22 to FY 2023-24

₹680.91 Cr
their combined spend over the three years

< ₹1 Cr
average per company: Bihar receives many small cheques, not anchor programmes

Three-year company count and total as stated by the Union Finance Minister in the Rajya Sabha. A company-wise top-20 ranking will be included in the 2027 edition.

Section 2:

Seven Development Challenges, Seven Investment Opportunities

Where CSR can change outcomes in Bihar

For each issue: what the data shows, where it hits hardest, what CSR can fund, and a ready-to-fund Orvys programme with an indicative budget.

Key findings

42.9%
of children under 5 are stunted (NFHS-5)

61.8%
literacy, the lowest of any state (Census 2011)

~73%
of Bihar's area is flood-prone

₹8.92 Cr
CSR reached the 7 flood-belt districts in FY24

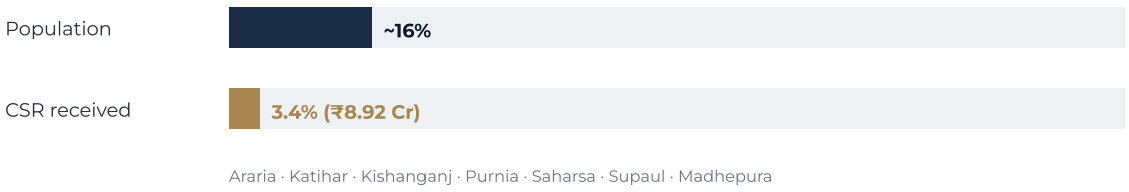
Needs and CSR are mismatched

Bihar's deepest needs are concentrated in the same districts that receive the least CSR.

#	Issue	Most affected	Where CSR can act	Orvys programme
01	**Child malnutrition**	Statewide; worst in Seemanchal and Kosi	Anganwadis, first 1,000 days	Poshan Bihar
02	**Foundational learning**	Rural government schools	Reading and maths, teachers, girls' transition	Padho Bihar
03	**Primary healthcare**	Aspirational districts	PHC upgrades, mobile clinics	Swasth Gaon
04	**Youth jobs & migration**	North and east Bihar	Skilling with placement	Hunar Bihar
05	**Floods & climate**	Kosi, Gandak and Bagmati basins	Early warning, shelters	Surakshit Kosi
06	**Women's livelihoods**	Statewide	SHG enterprises, market links	Didi Udyam
07	**Safe drinking water**	Ganga belt (arsenic), flood areas	Water plants, testing	Shuddh Jal

The Kosi-Seemanchal gap

Share of Bihar, FY 2023-24



Araria · Katihar · Kishanganj · Purnia · Saharsa · Supaul · Madhepura

Source: MCA, Rajya Sabha Unstarred Q. 1010; population, Census 2011; Orvys analysis

01

ISSUE

Child Malnutrition

More than four in ten young children in Bihar are stunted, one of the highest rates of any Indian state. The damage done in the first 1,000 days is largely irreversible.

42.9%	41.0%	69.4%	63.5%
children under 5 stunted	children under 5 underweight	children 6-59 months anaemic	women 15-49 anaemic

Source: National Family Health Survey (NFHS-5), 2019-21, Bihar

Districts to prioritise

Araria · Kishanganj · Purnia · Katihar · Sitamarhi · Sheikhpura · Nawada

What CSR can fund

- Model anganwadi centres with growth monitoring
- Counselling for pregnant women and new mothers
- Fortified take-home rations and nutrition gardens
- Anaemia test-and-treat camps for adolescent girls
- Community kitchens in flood seasons

ORVYS PROGRAMME

Poshan Bihar

Adopt 50-100 anganwadis in one aspirational district for three years, with an independent baseline and endline stunting and anaemia survey.

₹1.5-3 Cr

per district · 3 years · ~8,000 children reached

1,000 days

Highest return of any social investment

Nutrition in the first 1,000 days of life shapes lifelong learning, health and earnings, which makes it one of the most cost-effective uses of CSR.

02

ISSUE

Foundational Learning

Bihar has the lowest literacy rate of any Indian state and one of the widest gender gaps. Enrolment is now near-universal, but many children do not learn to read and count in the early grades.

61.8%
literacy rate, the lowest among states (India: 74.0%)

51.5%
female literacy rate

71.2%
male literacy rate: a gender gap of nearly 20 points

Source: Census of India 2011

Literacy rate: Bihar against India

% of population aged 7+, Census 2011



What CSR can fund

- Foundational literacy and numeracy (FLN) programmes in classes 1-3
- Remedial learning camps and community libraries
- Teacher training and classroom learning materials
- Girls' transition: bicycles, hostels, scholarships
- Smart classrooms in government high schools

ORVYS PROGRAMME

Padho Bihar

Cover every primary school in a block with an FLN programme measured against the government's NIPUN Bharat goals, run with the district education office.

₹0.75-1.5 Cr

per block per year · ~100 schools

03

ISSUE

Maternal & Primary Healthcare

Bihar's public health system serves more than 12 crore people with too few doctors, specialists and diagnostic facilities outside Patna. Families often travel out of the state for treatment, and many fall into debt as a result.

The challenge

PHC Rural coverage	**Thin rural capacity** Primary health centres and sub-centres in remote blocks often lack staff, equipment and diagnostics.
Floods Access	**Cut off for weeks** During floods, pregnant women and emergency patients in north Bihar can be cut off from care.
NCDs Rising burden	**Little screening** Diabetes, hypertension, cancer and eye disease are rarely screened for at village level.
Outside Care seeking	**Costly treatment far from home** Families travel to Patna, Delhi or Vellore for care, paying high out-of-pocket costs.

What CSR can fund

- PHC and community health centre upgrades with diagnostics and telemedicine
- Mobile medical units and boat clinics
- Ambulances and referral transport
- Cancer, diabetes and eye screening camps
- Training for ASHA and ANM health workers

ORVYS PROGRAMME

Swasth Gaon

Turn one PHC per block into a model hub with diagnostics and telemedicine, plus a mobile clinic serving the surrounding villages.

₹0.5-1 Cr

per hub · set-up and 2 years of operations

04 ISSUE

Youth Jobs & Distress Migration

Bihar has India's lowest per-capita income and one of its youngest populations. Millions of young people leave every year for low-wage, informal work in other states.

Lowest
per-capita income among Indian states

Youngest
one of India's youngest age profiles: a demographic window

Millions
of migrant workers send money home to Bihar

The challenge

- **Few local jobs:** Bihar has a small manufacturing base, so young people move to Delhi, Punjab, Gujarat and Maharashtra for work.
- **A skills gap:** many young people leave school without job-ready skills or recognised certification.
- **Vulnerable migrants:** they often lack social security, savings and decent housing.
- **An opportunity:** a skilled young workforce could make Bihar a hub for labour-intensive industry.

What CSR can fund

- Skilling centres with placement guarantees
- Apprenticeships with partner companies
- Digital, English and soft-skills training
- Rural enterprises and agri-processing units
- Migrant help desks, financial literacy and insurance

ORVYS PROGRAMME

Hunar Bihar

Train 500-1,000 young people a year in trades your company or sector hires for, with a target of 70% placement and tracking of their earnings.

₹1-2 Cr
per centre per year

05 ISSUE

Floods & Climate Risk

Bihar is India's most flood-prone state. The Kosi river is known as the "Sorrow of Bihar", and the districts at greatest risk receive the least CSR.

~73%
of Bihar's geographical area is flood-prone

28 of 38
districts are affected by floods

₹8.92 Cr
CSR in the 7 Kosi-Seemanchal districts, FY 2023-24

Sources: Water Resources Department and Disaster Management Department, Government of Bihar; MCA

Where it hits hardest

Supaul · Saharsa · Madhepura · Darbhanga · Sitamarhi · Pashchim Champaran · Khagaria · Katihar · Purnia

South Bihar has the opposite problem: Gaya, Nawada, Aurangabad and Jamui face recurring drought and heatwaves.

What CSR can fund

- Community early-warning systems and trained village response teams
- Raised flood shelters with hand pumps and toilets
- Flood-resilient housing and seed banks
- Climate-smart farming and solar irrigation
- Tree planting and pond revival in the drought-prone south

ORVYS PROGRAMME

Surakshit Kosi

Make 25-50 flood-prone villages disaster-ready: early warning, a raised shelter, safe water and a trained response team in each.

₹2-4 Cr
per cluster · 3 years

06

ISSUE

Women's Economic Participation

Very few women in Bihar work for pay outside the home. But JEEViKA, the state's rural livelihoods mission, has organised more than one crore women into self-help groups: a ready base for CSR to build on.

1 Cr+
women in JEEViKA self-help groups

51.5%
female literacy (Census 2011)

Low
female labour force participation, among India's lowest

The challenge

- **Stuck at small scale:** SHGs have savings and credit, but few of their enterprises grow beyond subsistence.
- **No route to market:** women producers lack branding, working capital and access to buyers.
- **Social barriers:** limits on mobility, the burden of care work and early marriage keep women out of jobs.

What CSR can fund

- Women-led producer companies (food processing, handloom, Madhubani and Sikki art)
- Branding, packaging and e-commerce listings
- Digital and financial literacy
- Childcare centres so that women can work

ORVYS PROGRAMME

Didi Udyam

An enterprise accelerator for 1,000 women from SHGs, run with JEEViKA and linked to your supply chain or retail partners.

₹1-2 Cr
over 2 years

07

ISSUE

Safe Drinking Water

Piped water now reaches most households, but water quality remains a serious health threat. Arsenic along the Ganga and contamination after floods expose millions of people.

The challenge

Arsenic Ganga belt	**A silent poison** Bhojpur, Buxar, Patna, Vaishali, Begusarai and Bhagalpur have groundwater with arsenic above safe limits, which causes skin lesions, cancers and organ damage.
F · Fe Fluoride, iron	**Other contaminants** Fluoride affects parts of south Bihar and iron affects the north-east.
Floods Seasonal	**Contaminated after floods** Floods pollute hand pumps and wells, and diarrhoea outbreaks follow.
O&M Sustainability	**Plants that stop working** Many water plants fail within a few years because no one is paid or trained to maintain them.

What CSR can fund

- Community arsenic-removal and RO plants
- Water testing kits and trained village water monitors
- Water, sanitation and hygiene (WASH) facilities in schools and anganwadis
- Rainwater harvesting and recharge

ORVYS PROGRAMME

Shuddh Jal

Install and run 20-40 community water plants in arsenic-affected panchayats. Each plant is run by a local entrepreneur so it pays for its own upkeep.

₹1-2.5 Cr

per network

Section 3:

Partnering for Bihar

An invitation to the Government of Bihar and India's corporates

Recommendations, a proposed State-Orvys partnership to bring more CSR into Bihar, and how companies can join the Bihar CSR Collaborative.

2030 ambition

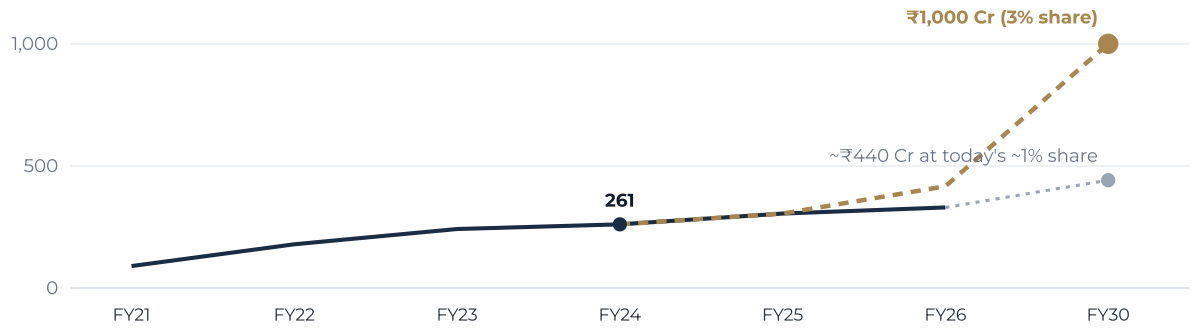
3%	₹1,000 Cr	38 / 38	1
Bihar's target share of India's state-attributed CSR (from 1%)	CSR a year flowing into Bihar	districts receiving ₹5 Cr+ a year	Bihar CSR Conclave every year in Patna

What it will take: recommendations

Companies Corporates & PSUs	**Make Bihar a priority geography** Each ₹1 Cr goes further where per-capita CSR is ₹25. Commit to multi-year programmes rather than one-off projects, and direct unspent CSR funds to long-term projects in aspirational districts.
State Govt. of Bihar	**Create a single window for CSR** Set up a State CSR Facilitation Cell and an online Bihar CSR portal with a district-wise list of fundable projects, and offer convergence or matching funds.
Districts DMs & DDCs	**Be ready for CSR** Name a CSR nodal officer in each district, publish ready-to-fund project lists, and track outcomes on district dashboards.
NGOs Implementers	**Build credibility** Register on CSR-1, keep 12A and 80G registrations current, report outcomes rather than just activities, and form district consortia to take on larger grants.

The Road to 2030: Orvys targets for CSR in Bihar

INR Cr a year



Actual FY 2020-21 to FY 2023-24 (MCA); FY 2024-25 onward are indicative Orvys estimates and targets.

AN INVITATION TO THE GOVERNMENT OF BIHAR

Bringing more CSR to Bihar: a State-Orvys partnership

Orvys invites the Government of Bihar, through its Industries, Planning & Development, and Rural Development departments and district administrations, to work with us to bring significantly more CSR investment into the state.

What we propose to build together

01 · State CSR Facilitation Cell

A single window, run by Orvys with the State, that matches companies to government-endorsed projects and smooths approvals.

02 · Bihar CSR Project Bank

A public online portal listing fundable, district-wise projects that are costed, approved and ready to start.

03 · Bihar CSR Conclave

An annual summit in Patna that brings CSR heads, PSUs and the State together, with MoUs signed on stage.

04 · Aspirational district focus

Matching and convergence support to steer CSR toward Kosi, Seemanchal and the other aspirational districts.

05 · Annual Bihar CSR data

This Outlook Report, published every year with the State, tracking district flows and outcomes.

06 · CSR outreach to companies

Targeted outreach to the top 500 CSR spenders and to PSUs with Bihar operations, inviting them to invest in the state.

What the State gains

- Hundreds of crores of additional private investment in social development
- CSR aligned with state priorities and flagship schemes
- Fairer flows to underserved districts
- Transparent, measurable outcomes

What Orvys brings

- CSR data and analysis for every district
- A network of corporate CSR teams and vetted NGOs
- Project design, monitoring and impact assessment
- A dedicated team to run the facilitation cell

Proposed next step: a meeting with the relevant departments to agree an MoU, then a launch of the Bihar CSR Collaborative at the first Bihar CSR Conclave in 2027.

CALL FOR CSR PARTNERS · 2026-27

Join the **Bihar CSR Collaborative**

Orvys invites companies, PSUs and foundations to bring their CSR to Bihar, where each rupee reaches more people and the need is greatest. Partner with the State and with Orvys to build Bihar's future.

₹25

CSR per person in Bihar today. Your rupee goes further here than almost anywhere else in India.

12 Cr+

people: about 9% of India, in its third most populous state

7

ready-to-fund programmes, each with a district plan and indicative budget

Why partner with Orvys

- **Ground knowledge:** district data, vetted NGOs and district administration links
- **Compliance handled:** Schedule VII alignment, CSR-1-registered implementers and documentation
- **Visibility:** recognition in the 2027 report and at the Bihar CSR Conclave
- **State backing:** projects aligned with Government of Bihar priorities
- **Measured impact:** baseline and endline studies, and a live dashboard
- **Pooled funds:** co-fund with others to reach greater scale

Ways to partner

Choose the level of involvement that fits your CSR budget and priorities.

Anchor ₹5 Cr+ · 3 yrs	**Anchor Partner** Lead a flagship programme across several districts and co-chair the Bihar CSR Collaborative. Co-branding on the report and the Conclave, and a seat on the advisory board.
District ₹1.5-5 Cr · 3 yrs	**District Champion** Adopt one aspirational district for a chosen issue. The district programme is named with your company and featured as a case study.
Programme ₹0.5-1.5 Cr / yr	**Programme Partner** Fund one of Programmes 1-7 in a block or a cluster of villages. Includes your logo in the report, field visits and an impact report.
Knowledge In-kind	**Knowledge Partner** Co-publish research, share data or offer employee volunteering. Acknowledged in the report.

How it works

01
Discover
We learn your CSR policy, focus areas and budget

02
Design
We propose a district, programme, partners and metrics

03
Deliver
Vetted NGOs implement, with monthly reports and a dashboard

04
Demonstrate
Independent impact assessment and stories for your annual report

Be part of the 2027 edition

Partners who sign on by **31 March 2027** will be featured in the Bihar CSR Outlook Report 2027 and invited to the first Bihar CSR Conclave in Patna.

Get in touch

[Name, Designation]
[email] · [phone]
[website]

Methodology & sources

Data

All CSR spend figures come from the Ministry of Corporate Affairs, drawn from companies' MCA21 filings and reported to Parliament, with data up to 31 March 2025. FY 2023-24 is the latest complete year. FY 2024-25 and FY 2025-26 values and the 2030 figures are indicative Orvys estimates and targets.

Limitations

In FY 2023-24, ₹7,962 Cr of national CSR was listed as "PAN India" or not tied to a state, and ₹16.41 Cr in Bihar was not tied to a district. Some of this may reach Bihar. Parliamentary replies do not give sector-wise or company-wise figures for Bihar; these will be added from the National CSR Portal in the 2027 edition. Programme budgets are indicative.

Sources

1. Rajya Sabha Unstarred Question 1010 (9 December 2025): district-wise and PSU/non-PSU CSR in Bihar, FY 2020-21 to FY 2023-24
2. Lok Sabha Unstarred Question 2338 (15 December 2025), Annexure-I: state-wise CSR, FY 2023-24
3. CSRBOX, India CSR Outlook Report 2026: national CSR totals
4. Ministry of Corporate Affairs, National CSR Portal: csr.gov.in
5. National Family Health Survey (NFHS-5), 2019-21, Bihar fact sheet
6. Census of India 2011
7. NITI Aayog, Aspirational Districts Programme
8. Government of Bihar: Water Resources Department and Disaster Management Department



About Orvys

Orvys works to bring more CSR investment to Bihar. We track CSR data for the state, design district-level programmes, and connect companies and the Government of Bihar with credible implementing partners on the ground.

[website] · [email] · Patna, Bihar

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